

AYSE SULE EKIZ

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Early-career product designer and computer science student who turns complex technical systems into clear, usable, and emotionally thoughtful product experiences. Experienced in Figma design systems, UX research, accessibility, interactive prototyping, AI-assisted development, and shipping live products with engineers. Comfortable designing for developer tools, dashboards, AI workflows, data-heavy interfaces, and real-time systems where clarity, trust, and detail matter.

EDUCATION

North American University — B.S. Computer Science / GPA 3.95

Aug 2024 – Present

Relevant coursework: Human-Centered Product Design · Software Engineering · Database Systems · Data Visualization · Statistics · ML & Big Data · Operating Systems · Computer Networks · Data Structures & Algorithms.

EXPERIENCE

IT & Design Associate — North American University

Sep 2024 – Present

Own product design, UX improvements, and front-end delivery for live campus platforms serving 1,000+ daily users across students, staff, administrators, and athletics.

- Designed and shipped campus-facing product experiences from stakeholder discovery to production, translating ambiguous administrative needs into user flows, interface requirements, and usable shipped features.
- Built and maintained a reusable Figma design system, component documentation, accessibility patterns, and developer handoff standards to improve consistency across campus web platforms.
- Conducted usability testing and A/B testing cycles, connecting session behavior, user feedback, and conversion metrics to product decisions used by university administrators.
- Completed WCAG 2.1 accessibility audits and improved interface clarity, navigation, and content hierarchy for student and athletics workflows.
- Automated Python reporting workflows, reducing manual staff overhead by 60% and making operational data easier to understand and act on.
- Collaborated closely with technical and non-technical stakeholders, balancing user needs, technical constraints, brand consistency, and implementation feasibility.

Software Engineering Intern — ForgeMind

Feb 2025 – Jul 2025

Worked across production services, analytics, telemetry, and performance optimization, strengthening the technical foundation needed to design clear tools.

- Partnered with stakeholders to understand product pain points, define requirements, and ship improvements across live Python services and data-driven dashboards.
- Profiled production services using py-spy, flame graphs, and SQL execution plans; identified bottlenecks and helped reduce dashboard render latency by 40%.
- Analyzed feature-adoption funnels, session engagement, and workload telemetry using SQL window functions, CTEs, cohort analysis, and product metrics.
- Translated behavioral and performance data into product insights, helping teams get how users interacted with live systems and where workflows broke down.
- Built resilient Python ETL pipelines with schema validation and fault-detection layers, improving the reliability of data used in product and reporting workflows.
- Developed a strong understanding of how observability, latency, data quality, and interface decisions affect user trust in technical products.

AI Research Intern — Koç University

Jun 2022 – May 2023

Improved research tooling and visualization for a 2D-to-3D deep learning reconstruction pipeline.

- Restructured Python preprocessing, labeling, and evaluation workflows, reducing per-iteration compute by approximately 30% and accelerating model testing.
- Built diagnostic JavaScript visualizations to expose model behavior, metrics, and failure modes in a clearer way for researchers and stakeholders.
- Helped make complex ML pipeline behavior more interpretable through visual feedback, debugging tools, and structured evaluation views.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Product Design: Interaction Design · Visual Design · UX Research · User Flows · Wireframing · Prototyping · Design Systems · Component Libraries · Developer Handoff · Accessibility · WCAG 2.1 · Usability Testing · A/B Testing · Information Architecture · Journey Mapping

Design Tools: Figma · FigJam · Adobe Creative Suite · Canva · AI-Assisted Design · Generative AI Prototyping · Claude Code · Cursor · Codex

Technical Prototyping: React · TypeScript · JavaScript · HTML/CSS · Vite · Next.js · Chrome MV3 · Electron · REST APIs · GraphQL familiar · JWT Auth

Data, Dashboards & Observability: SQL · PostgreSQL · MongoDB Atlas · Prometheus · Grafana · Telemetry Instrumentation · Dashboard Design · Data Visualization · Funnel Analysis · Cohort Analysis · Latency Optimization · Root-Cause Analysis

AI & ML: LLM Integration · Gemini · Gemma · RAG Pipelines · Embeddings · sqlite-vec · TensorFlow.js · Keras · PyTorch · MoveNet · MediaPipe · scikit-learn · TF-IDF · Model Evaluation

Backend & Tools: Node.js · Express · Python · Docker · Git/GitHub · Postman · Render · Vercel · Agile/Scrum

SELECTED PRODUCT & DESIGN PROJECTS

Full write-ups, live demos, and source code: [Projects Portfolio](#)

Obi — Local AI Desktop Assistant (LA Hacks 2026 · Figma Make Challenge Winner)

Apr 2026

Product Design · AI Prototyping · Electron · React · TypeScript · Local RAG · Figma

- Designed and built a local-first AI desktop assistant that indexes a user's files in real time and answers questions through hybrid keyword + semantic retrieval.
- Created a privacy-centered product experience where no data leaves the device, reducing user trust barriers common in cloud-based AI tools.
- Used Figma and rapid AI-assisted prototyping to shape the product concept, flows, and interface under a 36-hour hackathon timeline.
- Implemented the product in Electron, React, TypeScript, SQLite, sqlite-vec, and local Gemma inference; judged production-ready by industry evaluators.

Framewise — AI Video Workspace + Chrome Extension (HackHCC: Best Use of AI & MongoDB Atlas)

May 2026

Interaction Design · Chrome Extension · React · Node.js · Gemini · MongoDB Atlas · MoveNet

- React 18 web app and Chrome MV3 extension sharing one Node.js/Express backend and MongoDB Atlas database; turns any browser video into a searchable workspace with Gemini 2.5 Q&A, timestamped notes, quizzes, and MoveNet pose-tracking for real-time skeletal overlay.
- On-device BiLSTM classifier (Keras → int8 → TF.js, ~2MB) with sub-frame latency and zero network dependency; Prometheus + Grafana observability layer.

Whisperwind Grove — Multi-Game Platform with AI (CS Capstone · Full Marks)

Spring 2026

Creative Technology · Game UX · React 19 · TypeScript · Phaser 3 · Node.js · MongoDB · Gemini

- Designed and built a multi-game browser platform with four interconnected worlds, shared player identity, achievements, profiles, and leaderboards.
- Created playful interaction systems, onboarding flows, game feedback loops, and persistent progression mechanics across distinct gameplay modes.
- Integrated Gemini AI so an NPC could respond dynamically to player conversation and influence the live game state.
- Earned full marks across architecture, data modeling, testing, documentation, AI implementation, and production-quality delivery.

NAU Athletics & Student Portal — Live Campus Platform

Sep 2024 – Present

Product Design · UX Research · Figma · Accessibility · Design Systems · Developer Handoff

- Designed and shipped a live campus platform used by 1,000+ daily users, supporting athletics schedules, rosters, student workflows, and administrative content.
- Owned UX research, journey mapping, interface structure, Figma design system, accessibility audit, component documentation, and developer handoff.
- Improved clarity across multi-user workflows by designing navigation patterns and reusable components for students, staff, coaches, and visitors.
- Connected usability testing and social-channel conversion data to real product decisions, closing the loop between user behavior and design iteration.

OpenStaxAlign — ML Classification Pipeline (Rice Datathon 2026 · 2nd Place + OpenStax Track Winner)

Jan 2026

Data Visualization · ML Diagnostics · Python · scikit-learn · MongoDB

- Built an end-to-end ML classification pipeline for curriculum alignment, reaching 75% multi-class accuracy in one hackathon day.
- Used precision/recall diagnostics and confusion-matrix analysis to identify failure modes and guide iteration.
- Helped translate raw model outputs into a clearer curriculum story for educators and judges.

Reverie — Mood-Based Creative Spaces App

Dec 2025

Product Design · Emotional UX · Figma · React · Node.js · MongoDB

- Designed and built a full-stack creative journaling platform where users create emotional spaces from music, imagery, reflections, colors, and media.
- Started in Figma, then translated the visual system into a responsive MERN product with authentication, community discovery, saved collections, and timeline views.
- Focused on emotional UX, visual atmosphere, privacy, and self-expression rather than generic mood tracking.

LEADERSHIP & AWARDS

President, ACM-Women (2025–Present) — run technical workshops on full-stack development, applied AI, and CS fundamentals; mentor 50+ students on skill-building and career strategy; organize hackathon participation and community outreach.

Leader, Google Developer Student Club (2024–Present) — launched the GDSC chapter at NAU; organized workshops on emerging technologies and developer tools for students and faculty.

President, Design Club (2024 – 2025) — led workshops on Figma, visual communication, design principles, Canva, and Adobe Creative Suite; mentored students on design craft, storytelling, and audience-focused creative work.

Honors & Awards — **HackHCC: Code Runners** Best Use of AI & Best Use of MongoDB Atlas | **LA Hacks 2026** Figma Make Challenge Winner | **Rice Datathon 2026** 2nd Place OpenStax Track Winner | **CS Capstone** Full Marks | **President's Honor Roll** (all semesters).